

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

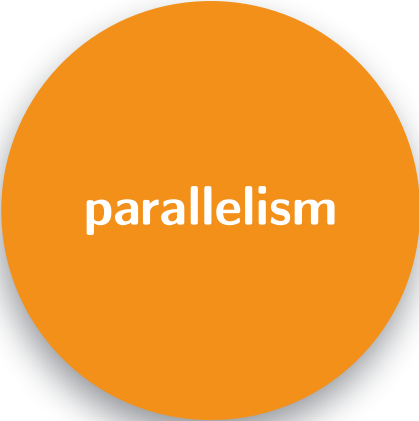
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .





Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?





One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.

One historically very important argument that there can be no causal connections of this kind was given by Elisabeth of Bohemia, a 17th century German philosopher.



“it seems every determination of movement happens from the impulsion of a thing moved, according to the manner in which it is pushed by that which moves it ... Contact is required for [this]. ... contact seems to me incompatible with the idea of an immaterial thing.”

Elisabeth here is considering a special case of causation: putting something in motion. For something to push something else, it seems that the two things must be in contact; and for two things to be in contact, both must occupy space (since being in contact is just a matter of occupying adjacent spaces). Since immaterial souls don't occupy space, it seems that they can't set things in motion — so, for example, my mind's desire for coffee can't be what sends my body down the hallway in search of some.

causal/physical properties.

properties, and

Physical properties can

causaphenomenal

One answer is: Yes.

phenomenal properties can

physical properties.

causal phenomena

Physical properties can

properties cannot cause

A second answer is: Yes.

properties; but phenomena

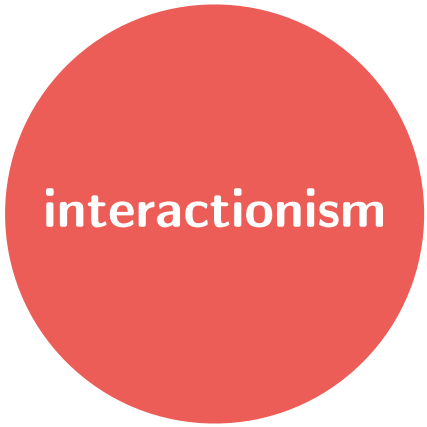
Third answer: No.

properties cannot causally

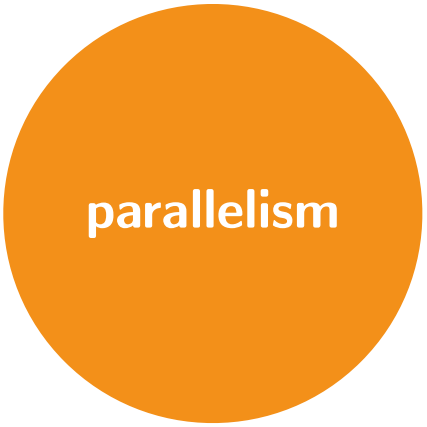


interact.

Physical and phenomenal



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle that fills most of the frame, serving as a background for the text.

parallelism

epi-

phenomenalism

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